

EXCEPTIONS TO SCHOOL ASSIGNMENT DUE TO ATTENDANCE ZONE CHANGE

All students who have been reassigned to a new or existing school in an attendance zone change under School Board Policy 6530, Changing School Attendance Zones, will be expected to attend the school to which they have been reassigned upon the opening of the new school and/or the attendance zone change taking effect.

A. Exceptions to School Assignment Due to Attendance Zone Change.

1. Rising Seniors. Students who will be entering grade twelve (rising seniors) at the time of the implementation of an attendance zone change will remain at their current school of assignment through graduation. It is the established tradition of the Loudoun County School Board to not open new high schools with a senior class for the school's inaugural year.

2. Siblings of Rising Seniors. Students who are already attending high school with an older sibling who is a rising senior may be granted permission by the School Board to voluntarily remain at their current school of assignment to enable them to continue attending high school with their older sibling(s) and remain at that same high school through graduation. Students who will be entering grade nine (rising freshmen) with an older sibling who is a rising senior, however, will need to apply for and be granted special permission under School Board Policy 8155, School Assignment, to attend freshman year at the high school of their older sibling.

3. Educational Continuity for Students Entering Grade Eleven, Eight or Five. Students who will be entering grade eleven (rising juniors), grade eight or grade five at the time of the implementation of an attendance zone change may be granted permission by the School Board to voluntarily remain at their current school of assignment in order to provide greater educational continuity for those students and/or to avoid recurring school changes for the student.

4. Early Attendance. Students reassigned to an existing school may be granted permission by the School Board to voluntarily begin attendance at their reassigned school prior to the attendance zone change officially taking effect, in order to better balance enrollment between existing schools and provide greater educational continuity for those students.

B. Process. The School Board will use one of the following processes in taking any action related to the foregoing potential exceptions to school assignment, due to an attendance zone change, prior to the attendance zone change officially taking effect:

1. Early Decision. As soon as reasonably possible following a school rezoning change decision by the School Board, staff will provide an analysis of the impact of the projected school enrollment of such exceptions.

2. Decision Resulting from a Survey. Alternatively, the School Board may

EXCEPTIONS TO SCHOOL ASSIGNMENT DUE TO ATTENDANCE ZONE CHANGE

choose to wait to make such a decision until after a survey can be conducted of the parent(s) or legal guardian(s) of any or all potentially eligible students to determine their interest in invoking any of the applicable exceptions. Surveys will typically be conducted within the year prior to the opening of the new school and/or the attendance zone change is due to take effect, unless related to early attendance.

C. Mandatory Survey Identification. Only those students who have been identified through the survey process and been granted permission by the School Board may be voluntarily excepted or gain early attendance to an existing school.

1. Students not enrolled at the time of surveying may still be granted permission to be excepted under this policy if sufficient capacity is determined to be available by Loudoun County Public Schools (LCPS) prior to the start of the school year.

2. Students who qualify for an exception but missed the survey deadline may be granted permission by staff to be excepted or given early attendance at an existing school, if doing so is consistent with actions taken by the School Board.

3. Late requests may be submitted within sixty (60) calendar days of School Board action granting permission to those students whose parent(s) or legal guardian(s) requested an exception through the survey process.

4. Staff decisions may be appealed to the School Board following the procedures in School Board Policy 2350, Appeal of Administrative Decisions.

D. Exception Approval. Students excepted or granted permission for early attendance through this policy will be permitted to remain at the school to which they have been excepted through graduation or their completion of studies at that educational level. Such permission is contingent upon the excepted student being in compliance with school rules and regulations.

E. Approval Rescission. An excepted student, who subsequently wants to rescind the permission granted with this policy and return/transfer to the student's regular school of assignment, must make such request in writing through the Division of Planning & GIS Services.

F. Virginia High School League (VHSL) Considerations. Identifying and evaluating all other ramifications of permission granted through this policy is the responsibility of the parent(s) or legal guardian(s), including but not limited to VHSL Handbook rules that are based upon a student's school assignment.

G. Transportation. The parent(s) or legal guardian(s) of a student who is excepted or permitted early attendance through this policy must commit to provide a means of

EXCEPTIONS TO SCHOOL ASSIGNMENT DUE TO ATTENDANCE ZONE CHANGE

reliable transportation for the student to and from school for the duration of the student's attendance at the school to which the student was otherwise excepted per this policy.

Transportation of the student may not be provided by LCPS in accordance with School Board Policy 6210, Student Transportation. If LCPS provides transportation for rising seniors, rising juniors who are excepted may be offered transportation for their junior year on a space-available basis only.

H. Request Outside of This Policy. Outside the survey process, any other student seeking to remain at a current school after being reassigned to another school or seeking to gain early attendance to a reassigned existing school following an attendance zone change must do so through School Board Policy 8155, School Assignment, or other applicable School Board policy.

[Former Policy 8-22]

Adopted: 1/23/01

Revised: 10/22/13, 3/11/14, 4/28/15, 1/23/18

Confirmed: 12/13/11, 9/7/22 (with technical changes)

Current Revision: 8/11/26

Cross Ref: Policy [2350](#), Appeal of Administrative Decisions; Policy [6530](#), Changing School Attendance Zones; Policy [6210](#), Student Transportation; Policy [8155](#), School Assignment